

SHOWCASE

SwitchBot Curtain

For all the lazy individuals out there, one of the most strenuous tasks is drawing and opening curtains. No, we're not joshing around. On a lethargic Sunday morning, this exact thing can feel like a Herculean task. Who has time for that? Not us... Enter SwitchBot Curtain, a smart device that powers up 'dumb' drapes. While there are already smart curtains on the market, those can be complex to install and often need to be plugged into an outlet. The SwitchBot Curtain eliminates the complexity since it is a smart, battery-powered device that gets added onto existing curtain rods. The company claims the device is compatible with almost all kinds of curtain rods or rails. Using the accompanying app, users can set SwitchBot Curtain on a predetermined schedule or simply operate on the spot. The device even comes fitted with a



light sensor that detects morning sunrise and opens up the drapes, and detects darkness and draws them back again. You can also tell Alexa to open/draw the drapes. Convenience? Check! Users can also switch it up and program it to close the drapes during the day to keep the harsh sunlight out. Even if you walk up to your window, simply tugging the curtain in a certain direction will cause them to open or close all the way. The best bit? One charge gets you 8 months, that's right, MONTHS of usage. Want to boost up that figure? Simply add an (optional) mini solar panel and have it charge itself. The product is currently available on Kickstarter at a pledge of \$49.



LaserPecker Pro

Fancy yourself a little custom engraving on-the-go but don't want to heave around a bulky engraver? The LaserPecker Pro is here for all your engraving needs while being fully portable. The engraver comes equipped with a 405-nanometer blue-violet laser that is allegedly good for about 10,000 hours of use. The LaserPecker Pro can burn graphics or text into an array of materials including fabric, wood, leather, plastic, metal, fruits (!?) and even more. It can even be set to burn through paperboard which opens up multiple applications such as creating laser-cut pieces of puzzles or even pieces for 3D models. How do you input the design or engravings, you ask? Simply send the graphic files to the device via Bluetooth from the accompanying Android/iOS app. The item that needs to be engraved sits on the flat surface below the engraver. The device employs yet another laser to accurately gauge the distance from the top of the object to itself and automatically raises or lowers the stand. Yet another laser is used to project the image of the engraving onto the object, allowing the user to manually make last-minute adjustments. In terms of protection, the Pro comes with a folding blue-light-blocking shield. The gadget automatically shuts down in case of overheating or if movement is detected. The expected retail price is \$399.

Harley-Davidson LiveWire Motorcycle

The Harley-Davidson LiveWire is the company's first-ever electric motorcycle which packs a massive battery pack (15.5 kWh) and an electric motor. The bike sports a muscular design and the electric motor and battery pack are set up in a way that it mimics an exposed engine. The motorcycle is quite lightweight since it features a cast aluminium frame. The Showa monoshock on the rear-end is fully adjustable as well. The bike offers a power output of about 78 kW or 104.6 bhp and a peak torque of 116 Nm. Considering the vehicle is electric, all that torque is available right from the get go, which is thrilling. The LiveWire offers a range of 235 kilometres on a single charge, which is quite exceptional, and the bike can be fully charged in just an hour.

There are a total of seven ride modes on offer, four of which are pre-programmed modes including Road, Rain, Sport and Range. The additional three modes are fully customisable and users can

manually set the power, regeneration, throttle response and traction control settings. The bike isn't manual, so you can kiss goodbye to the clutch and gear-shifting processes which can be tedious to learn. The Harley-Davidson LiveWire was supposed to be released in India in August, however, a charging problem had halted the production process. The company soon after announced that after conducting rigorous analysis, the production and deliveries processes have kickstarted again. This is Harley-Davidson's first venture into 'greener' modes of transportation.

